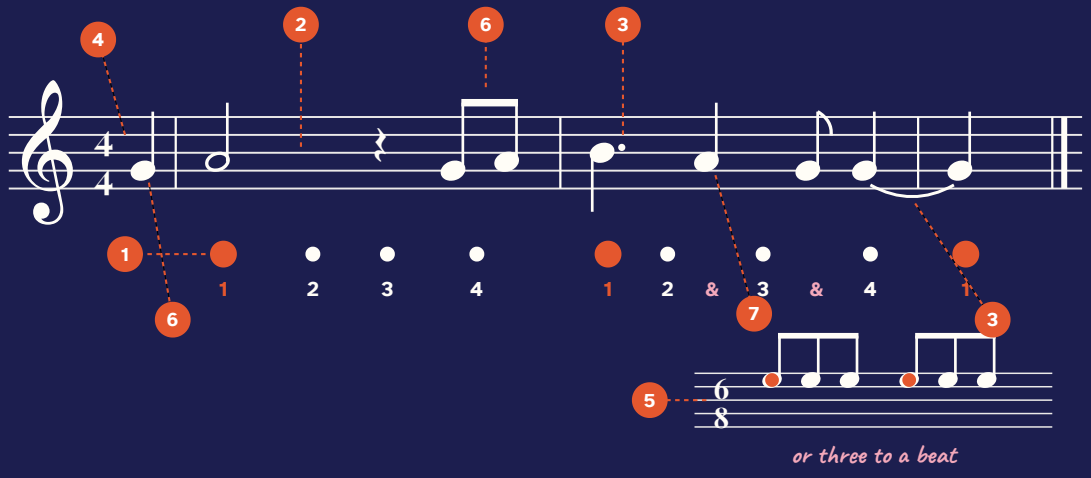
PART II · WHEN, AND FOR HOW LONG

Time

Music never stands still. Underneath runs a steady **pulse**, packed into **bars**, and every note and rest gets its fair share. Everything in this part is in these two bars.



1 **Pulse, tempo and the bar** p. 34
the steady beat under everything; beat 1 is strongest

2 **Notes and rests** p. 36
each shape says how long: a hollow note lasts twice a filled one; the rest is counted too

3 **How long is a note?** p. 39
a dot adds half; a tie glues two notes into one

4 **Time signatures** p. 41
four seats in every bar, a crotchet in each

5 **Compound and irregular time** p. 43
beats that split in three, or bars of five and seven

6 **Rhythm: groups and upbeats** p. 45
beams show the beats; a piece may start before bar 1

7 **Rhythm: off the beat** p. 47
a note that lands between the beats and holds on

★ **Tips: when the rhythm slips** p. 49